

## NEWS BRIEFING

Staff and news services

### Country singer Joe Diffie dies of coronavirus complications

NEW YORK — Country singer Joe Diffie, who had a string of hits in the 1990s with chart-topping ballads and honky-tonk singles like “Home” and “Pickup Man,” has died after testing positive for COVID-19. He was 61.

Diffie on Friday announced he had contracted the coronavirus, becoming the first country star to go public with such a diagnosis. Diffie’s publicist said the singer died Sunday in Nashville,

Tennessee, due to complications from the virus.

Diffie, a native of Tulsa, Oklahoma, was a member of the Grand Ole Opry for more than 25 years. His hits included “Honky Tonk Attitude,” “Prop Me Up Beside the Jukebox (If I Die),” “Bigger Than the Beatles” and “If the Devil Danced (In Empty Pockets).”

Diffie is survived by his wife, Tara Terpening Diffie, and seven children from four marriages.



TIZIANA FABI/GETTY-AFP

**The solitude of prayer:** A woman prays during the Sunday Mass celebrated by priests from the roof of the church San Gabriele dell'Addolorata in Rome amid the spread of the COVID-19 pandemic in Italy.

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